Hot water timer: how to use it

Sangamo PSS2 · Version 2026-10-14.02 · @Andy

> This is an unofficial quick guide to the Sangamo PSS2 timer in this property. It was put together from the manufacturer's manual and a demonstration video, with help from an AI tool. If the timer does not behave as described, stop and contact your landlord rather than trying other buttons. Do not open the timer or remove any screws.

Getting started

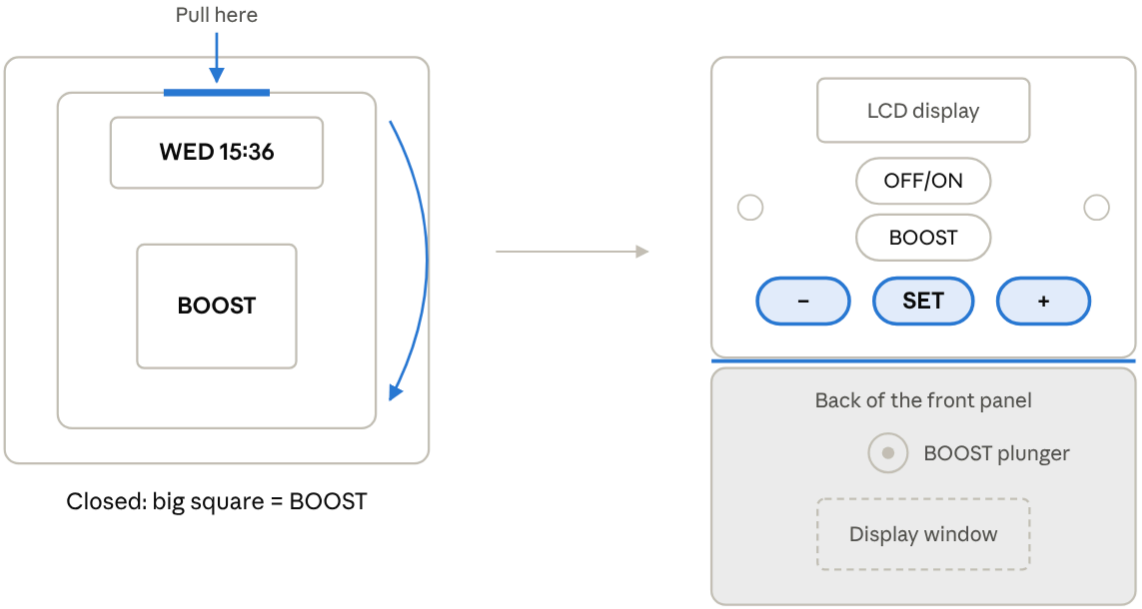
The timer **controls when the water heats**, so setting it to suit your day is the most important thing in this guide. The tank needs **around two hours to heat fully from cold**, so set each on time to start about two hours before you usually need hot water, for example from 6am for morning showers at 8am.

Using the timer well also helps **keep your electricity bills down**. Once heated, the tank stays hot for several hours, so there is no need to leave the heater on all day. **Heat the water shortly before you need it**, and keep the on times no longer than you need.

If you need extra hot water outside the set times, press the large square button on the front, which is **BOOST**. **It is not instant**: the tank still needs time to heat. To view or set the timer, use the small buttons behind the front panel.

To open the panel, hook a fingernail under its top edge and pull it towards you and down. It hinges at the bottom and hangs open, and the display stays on the unit. Do not touch the two screws either side of the buttons, and do not lever at the bottom of the outer white plate, because that is where the electrician's wiring is.

Pull the front panel down from its top edge to reach the buttons



Closed: big square = BOOST

Open: SET, – and + set the times

Leave the two screws alone

Timer closed and with the front panel open

With the panel open, you will see two buttons stacked in the middle and a row of three below them.

Button	Where	What it does
OFF/ON	Top of the middle pair	Pauses the timer while you are away
BOOST	Bottom of the middle pair	Extra hot water now (same as the large front button)
–	Bottom row, left	Lowers the flashing number
SET	Bottom row, middle	Moves to the next setting; press and hold to save and exit
+	Bottom row, right	Raises the flashing number

Times use the 24-hour clock, so 3pm is 15 and 5pm is 17. Holding – or + changes the number quickly.

I want hot water now

Press the large square button on the front. You do not need to open the panel, and the button still works when the keypad is locked.

Press BOOST	Display shows	Heater runs for
Once	0:30	30 minutes
Twice	1:00	1 hour
Three times	2:00	2 hours
Four times	0:00	Boost cancelled

The tank takes about two hours to heat fully, so for a full tank of hot water use the 2-hour boost. If you find yourself boosting often, it is easier and cheaper to change the set times instead.

When the boost ends, the timer goes back to its normal times by itself, so the schedule is not affected.

If the heater is already on during a scheduled time and you want it off, press BOOST once. It stays off until the next scheduled on time.

What times is it set to?

You can look through the saved times without changing anything, as long as you only press SET and never touch − or +.

1. Open the front panel.
2. Press SET (short presses) until the display shows **01** and **ON** beside a time. On the way it passes through the clock settings; SET alone leaves them unchanged.
3. Write down the time shown. That is when the heater first comes on.
4. Keep pressing SET. The display moves to **01 OFF** (first off time), then **02 ON**, **02 OFF**, and so on. Each time takes two presses, one for the hours and one for the minutes.
5. When a period shows **--:00**, nothing more is set and you have seen the whole schedule.
6. Press and hold SET until the normal clock display returns.

If you are not sure whether weekdays and weekends have separate times, the next section shows how to tell.

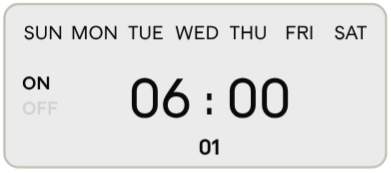
Which program is it on?

The timer runs on one of three programs, which the electrician chose when it was installed. You can check which one without changing anything.

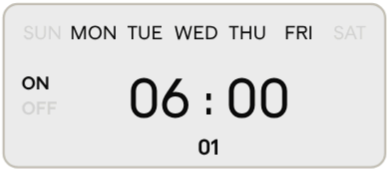
1. Open the front panel.

2. Press SET (short presses) until the display shows **01** and **ON**.
3. Look at which day names are lit along the top, and compare them with the pictures below.
4. Press and hold SET to go back to the normal display. As long as you have not pressed − or +, nothing has changed.

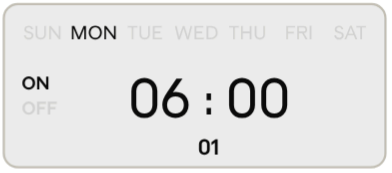
At 01 ON, the lit day names show the program



Program 1: same every day
All seven day names lit



Program 2: weekdays, weekend
MON to FRI lit, weekend later



Program 3: each day
One day lit, such as MON

Which day names are lit for each program

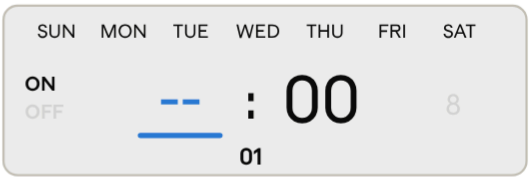
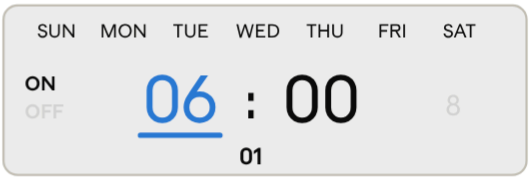
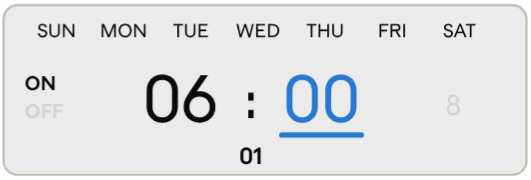
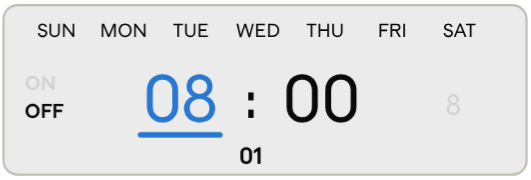
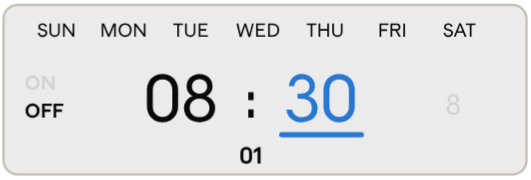
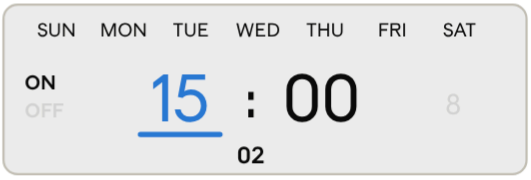
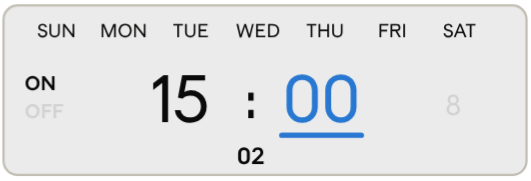
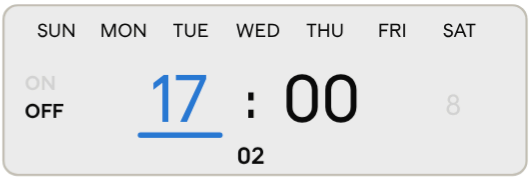
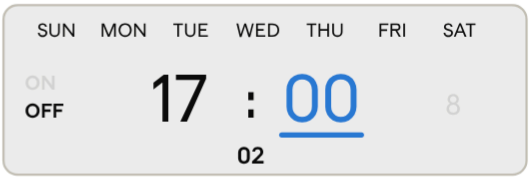
Only your landlord can change the program, because it means resetting the timer and setting it up again. If you need something different, such as separate times at weekends, tell your landlord which program it is on now and what you would like instead.

I want to change the times

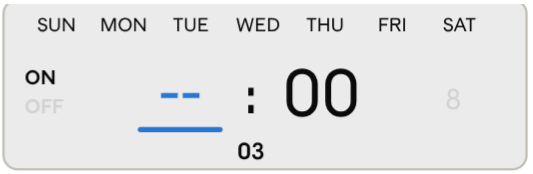
This example sets hot water from 6am to 8:30am and from 3pm to 5pm, every day. Whatever is flashing is what − and + will change, and SET moves you on to the next thing.

Set 06:00-08:30 and 15:00-17:00, one number at a time

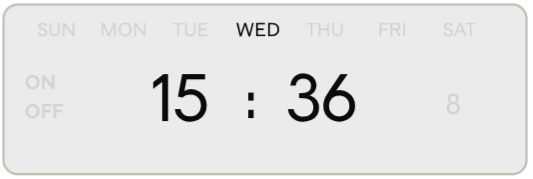
Highlighted, underlined digits are the ones flashing

What to do	What the display should show
1. Open the panel. Press SET (short presses) until the display shows 01 and ON. The hours flash (an old time may show instead of --).	
2. Hours: press − or + until they show 06, then press SET.	
3. The minutes flash. Press − or + until 00, then press SET.	
4. The display moves to 01 OFF. Hours: press − or + until 08, then press SET.	
5. Minutes: press − or + until 30, then press SET.	
6. The display moves to 02 ON. Hours: 15, then press SET.	
7. Minutes: 00, then press SET.	
8. The display moves to 02 OFF. Hours: 17, then press SET.	
9. Minutes: 00, then press SET.	

10. The display moves to 03 ON and should show --:00. If it shows a time, press − on the hours until -- appears.



11. Press and hold SET until the normal clock returns. Your new times are saved.



Setting the times step by step, with the display at each step

Times must go in order through the day, so period 1 has to be earlier than period 2. If the display shows an error, press SET and enter that period again; the other periods are kept.

If weekdays and weekends have separate times (see the previous section), do not hold SET after step 10. Keep pressing SET until Saturday and Sunday light up, enter the same times again for the weekend, and then hold SET to save.

I'm going away

Open the front panel and press OFF/ON once. The display shows **OFF**, and the heater will not come on at its scheduled times. Your saved times are kept.

When you get back, press OFF/ON again and the normal display returns. If you need hot water while the timer is paused, BOOST still works.

The clocks have changed

The timer does not change for summer and winter time by itself, so do this in late March and late October.

With the normal clock showing, press and hold BOOST. The clock should move by one hour, between summer time (BST) and winter time (GMT). Your on and off times move with it, so 6am still means 6am. Check the clock afterwards, and press and hold BOOST again if it moved the wrong way.

If the clock is wrong by some other amount, open the panel, then press and hold SET from the normal display. Use − or + to correct whatever is flashing (day, then hours, then minutes), pressing SET after each, then press and hold SET to save.

Something's not working

What you see	What to do
L appears when you press a button	The keypad is locked. Press and hold − and + together for 5 seconds until **L** shows briefly, then try again.
OFF on the display	The timer is paused for a holiday. Press OFF/ON once.
An error while entering times	A time is out of order. Press SET and enter that period again, making sure each period is later than the one before.
No hot water at a set time	Check the clock and day are right, and that **OFF** is not showing. Then press BOOST twice so the display shows 1:00. If the water is still cold when the boost has finished, tell your landlord, as the heater may need looking at.
SET never reaches **01 ON**	Stop and tell your landlord. They can put it right.